The Touch of Ancient Evil: OSINT - Beginner

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Description

This OSINT challenge where players are given a heavily distorted frame from a well known animated series. Their goal is to identify the exact episode in which the scene originates. Participants must use contextual clues, visual forensics, and knowledge of the show's "lore" to trace the corrupted image back to its original source. No geolocation or external exploits are required, only the ability to recognize patterns, interpret narrative hints, and match the frame to the correct moment in the series.

Github Path: https://github.com/Capture-The-Flame/Capture_The_Flame_2026/Cryptography/The_Touch_Of_Ancient_Evil/

Prompt

A small creature of the realm has been touched by an ancient evil.
Once a harmless wanderer, it now bears eyes of green flame.
It was last seen deep within a cavern where a great poison was sealed,
at the very moment that corruption first took hold of it.
Seek the tale in which the creature was first claimed by the Lich.

Hints

1. This little creature appears in nearly every tale, quietly watching from the background.
2. The corruption you seek did not begin when the Lich escaped, but the moment a harmless friend was touched by his influence inside the prison chamber.
3. Look closely at the creature's shape: a shield around its small body and little eyestalks. It is never threatening…unless its eyes glow green.

Solution

1. The hints describe a tiny being that appears in almost every episode. When paired with eyestalks, small body, and green glowing eyes, players can figure out this is referring to the Snail from Adventure Time who is famously seen waving in the background of many episodes.
2. The corruption didn’t begin when the Lich escaped,but when the snail was first touched by the Lich’s influence inside of the prison chamber. Participants should search for “Adventure time snail green eyes first corruption” or something similar. This is during the first corruption, not the later escape scenes.
3. Once they know the creature and the specific moment, they can search for the episode where the snail’s eyes glow green for the

very first time. This will lead them to season 2, episode 24 called “Mortal Folly”

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